Egyptian Boeing 737 that was carrying the hijackers and forced it to land at an air base operated jointly by the United States and Italy on Sicily. After that, I was up half the night on the telephone, monitoring the operation's progress, then its aftermath.

After the airliner landed, our team of navy Seals, who had been rushed to the base on Sicily, tried to arrest the hijackers so that they could be brought to America for trial. But Italian police officials refused and took custody of them. I made a late-night call to Bettino Craxi, the prime minister of Italy, and, citing Klinghoffer's American citizenship, asked him to allow us to fly the hijackers to the United States for prosecution. But he said he didn't have authority to release them; under Italian law, he said, magistrates were independent of the government and the fate of the four men was lawfully in their hands. (I think he was also worried about the political ramifications that he would face if hijackers of an Italian ship were released to us.)

When we broke the news to the press that the hijackers had been caught, I said I hoped the incident had sent a message to terrorists: You can run, but you can't hide. In my diary, I wrote, "Americans as well as friends abroad are standing six inches taller. We're flooded with wires and calls."

In late November, after I came home from the Geneva summit, Bud McFarlane told me he wanted to resign as my national security advisor at the end of the year. After thirty years of working for the government, he said he owed it to his family to spend more time at home. Bud was an eighty-hour-a-week man. I told him he could stay as long as he wanted, but I wouldn't try to talk him out of leaving; I sympathized with his desire to spend more time with his family. As Bud's successor, I appointed his deputy, John Poindexter, who had been in charge of the successful